

Unit 6: PDP Questions

UNIT 6: PERSONAL DEVELOPMENT PLAN

Question Guide (All Sections)

Instructions: Use these questions to create your personal development plan. Write your answers on separate paper or in your workbook.

SECTION 2.1: IDENTIFY SKILLS REQUIRED FOR A CAREER IN CYBERSECURITY

(15 Questions)

Technical Skills

1. What programming languages do you know that could be useful in cybersecurity?
(Example: Python, Java, C++)
2. What networking skills do you have?
(Example: TCP/IP, routers, switches, network troubleshooting)
3. Are you familiar with any operating systems for cybersecurity tasks?
(Example: Linux, Windows, macOS)
4. Do you know how to use any cybersecurity tools or software?
(Example: Wireshark, Nmap, Metasploit, firewalls)
5. Do you have knowledge of security concepts or frameworks?
(Example: encryption, threat modeling, incident response)

Practical Experience

6. Have you completed any hands-on projects or home labs related to cybersecurity?
(Example: building a website, configuring a firewall, virtual lab setups)
7. Have you participated in competitions, Capture The Flag (CTF) challenges, or hackathons?

- 8.** Have you contributed to open-source projects or personal coding projects that demonstrate your skills?
- 9.** Do you have experience analysing data, logs, or system behaviour?
- 10.** Have you done any internships, volunteering, or practical work that is relevant to cybersecurity?

Soft Skills

- 11.** What problem-solving or analytical skills do you have that would help in cybersecurity?
- 12.** What communication or teamwork skills do you have?
(Example: explaining technical issues clearly, working with a team on projects)
- 13.** What personal qualities help you succeed under pressure?
(Example: attention to detail, persistence, adaptability)

Achievements & Learning

- 14.** Have you completed any certifications, courses, or awards that demonstrate your skills?
(Example: online courses, school achievements, coding certifications)
 - 15.** Are there areas you feel you still need to develop to succeed in cybersecurity?
(Example: advanced networking, SIEM tools, incident response, professional communication)
-

SECTION 2.2: PERFORM PERSONAL SKILLS ANALYSIS (SWOT)

(20 Questions)

STRENGTHS

- 1.** What technical skills do you have that you are confident in?
(Example: programming, networking, Linux/Windows, cybersecurity tools)
- 2.** What practical experiences or projects have you completed that show your abilities?
(Example: home labs, school projects, competitions, CTFs)
- 3.** What personal qualities help you succeed in challenging tasks?
(Example: attention to detail, problem-solving, persistence)
- 4.** What soft skills do you feel are your strongest?
(Example: teamwork, communication, leadership, adaptability)
- 5.** Are there achievements or recognitions you are proud of that demonstrate your strengths?
(Example: awards, certifications, completed courses)

WEAKNESSES

6. What technical skills do you feel you are lacking or not confident in?

(Example: firewall management, SIEM tools, log analysis, advanced networking)

7. Which soft skills could you improve to work more effectively in teams or projects?

(Example: communication, time management, public speaking)

8. Are there gaps in your practical experience that make you feel less prepared?

(Example: few labs, limited hands-on practice, no CTF experience)

9. Are there personal habits that sometimes hold you back?

(Example: procrastination, difficulty prioritizing tasks)

10. Do you find certain concepts or areas in cybersecurity difficult to understand?

(Example: terminology, threat detection, incident response)

OPPORTUNITIES

11. What online courses, certifications, or resources are available to you to enhance your skills?

(Example: free courses, vendor certifications like NSE4, YouTube tutorials)

12. Are there clubs, communities, or competitions that could help you gain experience?

(Example: cybersecurity clubs, CTF competitions, online forums)

13. Can mentorship or networking opportunities help you progress?

(Example: connecting with professionals, joining LinkedIn groups)

14. Are there tools or software you could access to practice more effectively?

(Example: virtual labs, simulation tools, coding platforms)

15. Are there ways to gain practical experience through volunteering, internships, or personal projects?

(Example: helping with small IT projects, participating in open-source projects)

THREATS

16. Are there time constraints that make it hard to dedicate hours to learning or practice?

(Example: school, work, family commitments)

17. Are there financial limitations affecting your ability to access courses, labs, or tools?

18. Could lack of mentorship or guidance slow your progress?

19. Is competition or high standards in cybersecurity a concern for you?

20. Are there personal challenges that could prevent consistent learning or skill development?
(*Example: motivation, stress, limited access to equipment*)

SECTION 2.3: ASSESS OWN SKILLS AGAINST THOSE REQUIRED FOR A CAREER IN CYBERSECURITY

(15 Questions)

Technical Skills

- 1.** What programming languages do you already know that could help in cybersecurity?
(*Example: Python, Java, Bash*)
- 2.** What networking knowledge or experience do you have?
(*Example: TCP/IP, routers, switches, configuring networks*)
- 3.** Which operating systems are you comfortable using?
(*Example: Linux, Windows, macOS*)
- 4.** Have you used any cybersecurity tools or software?
(*Example: Wireshark, Nmap, firewalls, SIEM tools*)
- 5.** Do you understand any security concepts or frameworks?
(*Example: encryption, threat modeling, incident response*)

Practical Experience

- 6.** Have you completed any hands-on projects or home labs related to cybersecurity?
- 7.** Have you participated in Capture The Flag (CTF) competitions, hackathons, or challenges?
- 8.** Have you contributed to open-source projects, coding projects, or personal IT projects?
- 9.** Do you have experience analyzing data, logs, or system behavior for insights or security issues?
- 10.** Have you had internships, volunteering, or practical work relevant to cybersecurity?

Soft Skills & Achievements

- 11.** What problem-solving or analytical skills do you feel confident about?
- 12.** What communication or teamwork skills do you have?
(*Example: explaining technical issues clearly, working in groups*)
- 13.** What personal qualities help you succeed under pressure or in challenging tasks?
(*Example: attention to detail, persistence, adaptability*)

- 14.** Have you completed any certifications, courses, or awards that show your skills?
(*Example: online courses, school achievements, coding certifications*)
- 15.** Are there areas or skills you feel you still need to develop to succeed in cybersecurity?
(*Example: advanced networking, SIEM tools, incident response, professional communication*)
-

SECTION 2.4: CREATE A PERSONAL DEVELOPMENT PLAN

(17 Questions)

SECTION 1: Understanding Where I Am Now

- 1.** What certifications or qualifications am I currently working on or have completed?
- 2.** What technical skills do I currently have?
(*programming languages, cybersecurity knowledge, tools*)
- 3.** What practical experience do I have?
(*projects, home labs, hands-on practice*)
- 4.** What are my strongest skills right now?
- 5.** What skills or knowledge do I feel I'm lacking?

SECTION 2: Understanding My Career Goals

- 6.** What specific cybersecurity role am I aiming for?
- 7.** What skills does this role require that I don't have yet?
- 8.** What motivates me to pursue this career path?

SECTION 3: Understanding My Constraints and Resources

- 9.** How many hours per week can I realistically dedicate to learning and development?
- 10.** What resources do I have access to?
(*free training, budget, equipment, software*)
- 11.** What obstacles might prevent me from achieving my goals?
- 12.** When do I want to achieve my main career goal?

SECTION 4: Identifying My Specific Goals

- 13.** What certification do I want to complete next and by when?
- 14.** What technical skill do I most need to develop for my target role?

15. What practical project or hands-on experience would strengthen my portfolio?

16. What soft skill do I need to improve?

17. What else would help me become more employable in cybersecurity?

SUMMARY

Total Questions: 67 - Section 2.1: 15 questions - Section 2.2: 20 questions - Section 2.3: 15 questions - Section 2.4: 17 questions

Write your answers on separate paper, in a notebook, or in the official Unit 6 Worksheet provided by your tutor.

Document Version: 1.0

Last Updated: January 28, 2026

NCFE Level 3 Cybersecurity